Success Story

Sage People empowers Achilles' global workforce

Global supply chain manager automates HR functions to boost transparency

"Sage People helps us to communicate more effectively in a timely manner which can be tracked and recorded direct to targeted recipients."

Isobel Davies
Head of HR, Achilles

The Challenge

Achilles sought a solution to standardise communications better across its global network, and to move away from excel spreadsheets. It also needed a system that could automatically generate personalised emails in different languages.

The Solution

By having a central data system, Achilles could put people at the heart of its business with transparent reporting. Personalised communications enabled the company to connect with employees and the Sage People self-service function empowered employees to own and update their personal information.

The Result

Achilles now generates personalised communications and reports in one click. Sage People's internal communications function is used to announce new policies worldwide, help employees navigate benefits, ask questions, and more. Job vacancies are also automatically advertised internally and externally.

- Automated annual salary review letters saving two days HR time.
- Automated reports with trusted data eliminating doubt.
- Improved visibility, transparency and track record for company audits.
- Self-service function, saving HR time to focus on company priorities.

Company
Achilles

Location
United Kingdom, with locations worldwide

Industry
Technology & Software

Sage Products
Sage People

Achilles

About Achilles
Achilles is the world-leading expert in procurement and supply chain regulation, health and safety, financial and cyber risk, as well as sustainability and carbon management.

Sage

Transparency and integrity of data across the globe
For over 30 years, Achilles has protected organisations' business interests and reputations by providing unrivalled levels of supply chain transparency, carbon reduction and management for the world's leading global brands. With 22 offices across the world, the organisation has a diverse team of professionals with varying HR requirements.

Having inherited the Sage People global HR system just under two years ago, HR Director, Isobel Davies and her HR team were acutely aware of the importance of optimising employee experiences and engagement to work in a more connected way across the globe. So, they started utilising Sage People to automate communications and provide the means for a two-way conversation with employees through the Sage People platform.

Given the nature of the business, data integrity, security and transparency were imperative. Sage People enabled them to keep a track record of all communications which was key for company audits.

Connecting better
On a daily basis, the HR team use the Sage People communications tool to announce new policies, benefits and well-being initiatives across offices, tailored to each country. The Sage People Recruit functionality also empowers managers to post job adverts directly on the internal and external sites.

Isobel explains, "We post job adverts on our website or other job boards, update our team members on our home page, ensure that policy documents are updated and recorded as read and sent, and send salary review letters to employees. This results in increased engagement and reduced admin."

The team have also automated the annual salary review letters across 17 territories and 500+ employees, personalised to each employee based on their job role, salary, location and language.

"Sage People provides really good flexibility and versatility in managing the dual languages of our business," says Isobel. "It's being used consistently for absence management, employment details, personal detail changes, HR requests and resourcing."

Previously HR would manually generate each letter from a spreadsheet and then email each manager a selection which they would then distribute themselves. Now letters can be automatically generated and simultaneously emailed to each employee directly, saving approximately two days of HR time.

The leadership is now receiving data that they can trust.

Empowering employees through self service

Achilles employees are empowered to own and update their personal information such as change of address or bank details and to manage and book requests for leave. Performance reviews are also recorded on the Sage People platform enabling employees to refer to their objectives and goals at any time. This saves HR valuable time.

"The employee and manager self-service functionality reduces HR admin allowing us to focus on other priorities whilst reassuring us that we have up to date and accurate information," says Isobel.

Because the Sage People platform is secure, it also provides reassurance that the data will not be compromised or lost, as is common with the spreadsheets of old, and with careful security settings only authorised people are permitted to access certain data.

"With the ability to set different security and role profiles in Sage People, we have the confidence that we can give different people the access that they need to do their jobs without meaning that we have to do everything for them," she continues.

Automated reporting

Another time-saving aspect of the platform is the reporting automation. Sage People automatically generates regular reports on headcounts, payroll data, employee information, and attrition for the finance team, in addition to absence and vacations reports.

"We can look at different parameters and run reports for a quarter or a year. I have even set up monthly reports for our Head of Financial Planning and Analysis that are automatically sent to him on the first day of the month without me even seeing them," says Isobel.

Reports use data from Sage People records and can be sliced and diced at a click of a button depending on the organisation's needs and presented in a simple but visual way to help colleagues extract meaningful insights from.

Perhaps most importantly is that the leadership is now receiving data that they can trust.

"When I first started, our CEO was worried because he was getting different numbers from different sources. The same with finance who we interact a lot with for things like headcount and cost of hire. They are much more confident in the data now," says Isobel.

Customer support

Having recently started at Achilles and inherited Sage People, Isobel and her team are yet to use the full functionality of the platform, but their Sage customer success manager has been instrumental in guiding them through it. Regular monthly review calls are held in addition to ad hoc support from the responsive Sage support help desk.

"We can give different people the access they need without us have to do everything for them."

Isobel Davies
Head of HR, Achilles

Big plans for the future

Through the Sage People platform, Achilles has improved communications and engagement, creating a culture of transparency and engagement across the worldwide network. Next up, the company plans to use Sage People for its workforce planning enabling the company to maintain its long-standing position as expert in supply chain management at the forefront of the battle against climate change, a champion for social justice and human rights, and an expert in health, safety, and risk management.

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